

# The Boston Globe

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## A new fight over college admission

### Suit targets elite schools' early decision policies

By Travis Andersen and Spencer Buell

GLOBE STAFF

The early decision process at US universities has long been criticized as a pernicious system that benefits wealthy families at the expense of middle-class and disadvantaged students, while others argue it can bring peace of mind to applicants certain of their first choice and eager to avoid the stress of a broader search.

Now, a new lawsuit takes aim at another critique of the system: that it is fundamentally unfair because it prevents applicants from shopping around for a better financial aid package from other schools and inflates the cost of a college degree.

On Friday, three current college students and one recent graduate filed a lawsuit in federal court in Massachusetts against dozens of elite schools, including several in Massachusetts, alleging that early decision amounts to a conspiracy that pressures applicants to accept conditions that are not le-

EARLY DECISION, Page A10

## Trump seeks to use troops against drug cartels

By Helene Cooper, Maggie Haberman, Charlie Savage, and Eric Schmitt

NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — President Trump has secretly signed a directive to the Pentagon to begin using military force against certain Latin American drug cartels that his administration has deemed terrorist organizations, according to people familiar with the matter.

The decision to bring the US military into the fight is the most aggressive step so far in the administration's escalating campaign against the cartels. It signals Trump's continued willingness to use military forces to carry out what has primarily been considered a law enforcement responsibility to curb the flow of fentanyl and other illegal drugs.

The order provides an official basis for the possibility of direct military operations at sea and on foreign soil against cartels.

US military officials have started drawing up options for how the military could go after

TRUMP, Page A7

## Sheriff facing extortion charges

Suffolk official allegedly got stock deal by threatening cannabis company



GLOBE STAFF/FILE

Suffolk County Sheriff Steven W. Tompkins must report to court in Boston by Aug. 15.

By Sean Cotter and Nick Stoico

GLOBE STAFF

Suffolk County Sheriff Steven W. Tompkins, a ubiquitous, glad-handing Democrat in Boston political circles, was arrested by federal authorities Friday on charges of allegedly extorting a cannabis company, under the threat he would revoke a partnership with his office that was central to the company's licensing application.

Prosecutors allege that in addition to forcing a company offi-

cial to sell him stock before the venture went public for \$50,000, Tompkins subsequently demanded he be repaid after the value of his shares sank below his initial investment.

Tompkins, 67, was indicted in federal court in Boston on two counts of extortion under color of official right, which carry a maximum sentence of 20 years in federal prison. He was arrested in Florida and released on \$200,000 bond after a brief appearance in federal court Friday. He must report to court in

Boston by Aug. 15.

"Today, he is alleged to have extorted an executive from a cannabis company, using his official position as Sheriff to benefit himself," US Attorney Leah B. Foley said in a statement. "Elected officials, particularly those in law enforcement, are expected to be ethical, honest and law abiding — not self-serving."

Tompkins did not respond to requests for comment.

Tompkins has served as sheriff since 2013, overseeing the

Nashua Street and South Bay jails in Boston and other detention operations in Suffolk County. He was initially appointed sheriff by former governor Deval Patrick, and then won the seat in the following election.

He has been very active in local Democratic politics, offering up endorsements and seeking his own. He's appeared at rallies and campaign events alongside leading political figures, including Boston Mayor Michelle Wu, and once served as a campaign adviser to Senator Elizabeth Warren.

TOMPKINS, Page A6

## LEARNING THE ROPES



PHOTOS BY DAVID L. RYAN/ GLOBE STAFF



The Mayflower II set sail for the first time in five years this week, leaving Plymouth Harbor for several training sessions and then a six-hour jaunt around Cape Cod Bay. Being on the ocean in the ship, a full-size replica of the vessel the Pilgrims traveled in, "just brings the history to life," said Tom Begley, executive director of Plimoth Patuxet Museums. Above, crew members maneuvered the sails during a training trip. Left, the ship on a training run. **B2.**



BARRY CHIN/GLOBE STAFF

## BIG MAN BACK ON CAMPUS

The New England Patriots unveiled a statue of quarterback Tom Brady at Gillette Stadium before Friday's preseason game against the Commanders. Brady was welcomed by team owner Robert Kraft, past teammates, and thousands of fans. The bronze figure of Brady is 12 feet tall, reflecting his jersey number, and the statue's overall height is 17 feet, in honor of his 17 division championships. **Sports, C1.**

JAMES A. LOVELL JR. 1928-2025

## Apollo 13 commander survived near-disaster

By Richard Goldstein

NEW YORK TIMES

James A. Lovell Jr., the commander of the three-man Apollo 13 spacecraft that survived a near catastrophic explosion as it approached the moon in April 1970, before safely returning to Earth in an extraordinary rescue operation, died Thursday in Lake Forest, Ill. He was 97.

His death was confirmed by his daughter-in-law, Darice Lovell. He lived in Lake Forest.

Captain Lovell, a former Navy test pilot, flew for some 715 hours in space, the most of any astronaut in the pioneering Mercury, Gemini, and Apollo programs forged by the United States as it vied with the Soviet Union to put a man on the moon by the end of the 1960s.

He took part in two Gemini missions that orbited Earth and was one of the three astronauts aboard Apollo 8, the first spaceflight to orbit the moon, before he was chosen by

LOVELL, Page A10

The Trump administration is demanding that Harvard produce a list of patents stemming from federally funded research grants. **B1.**

Israel's vow to intensify its war with Hamas by taking over Gaza City is stirring fears for Palestinian civilians and Israeli hostages still held in Gaza. **A4.**

State tax revenue exceeded predictions by \$2 billion. **B1.**



### Sea going

**Saturday:** Sunny, nice. High: 74-79. Low: 62-67.

**Sunday:** Sunny, warmer. High: 82-87. Low: 68-73.

Comics and Weather, **D4-5.** Obituaries, **C9.**

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